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FEATURES

NYT Connections Sports Edition today: Hints and answers for March 28, 2026

Mashable Tech

Today's Connections: Sports Edition is for people who live in Michigan.

As we've shared in previous hints stories, this is a version of the popular New York Times word game that seeks to test the knowledge of sports fans.

Like the original Connections, the game is all about finding the "common threads between words." And just like Wordle, Connections resets after midnight and each new set of words gets trickier and trickier — so we've served up some hints and tips to get you over the hurdle.

If you just want to be told today's puzzle, you can jump to the end of this article for the latest Connections solution. But if you'd rather solve it yourself, keep reading for some clues, tips, and strategies to assist you.

SEE ALSO:

Mahjong, Sudoku, free crossword, and more: Play games on Mashable

What is Connections: Sports Edition ?

The NYT's latest daily word game has launched in association with The Athletic, the New York Times property that provides the publication's sports coverage. Connections can be played on both web browsers and mobile devices and require players to group four words that share something in common.

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Each puzzle features 16 words and each grouping of words is split into four categories. These sets could comprise of anything from book titles, software, country names, etc. Even though multiple words will seem like they fit together, there's only one correct answer.

If a player gets all four words in a set correct, those words are removed from the board. Guess wrong and it counts as a mistake — players get up to four mistakes until the game ends.

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Players can also rearrange and shuffle the board to make spotting connections easier. Additionally, each group is color-coded with yellow being the easiest, followed by green, blue, and purple. Like Wordle, you can share the results with your friends on social media.

SEE ALSO:

Wordle-obsessed? These are the best word games to play IRL.

Here's a hint for today's Connections: Sports Edition categories

Want a hint about the categories without being told the categories? Then give these a try:

Yellow: Teams in the mitten

Green: An at-bat

Blue: Teams with a similar color

Purple: Types of cards

Here are today's Connections: Sports Edition categories

Need a little extra help? Today's connections fall into the following categories:

Yellow: Michigan Teams

Green: Outcomes in an at-bat

Blue: "Red" Teams

Purple: ____Card

Looking for Wordle today? Here's the answer to today's Wordle.

Ready for the answers? This is your last chance to turn back and solve today's puzzle before we reveal the solutions.

Drumroll, please!

The solution to today's Connections: Sports Edition #550 is...

What is the answer to Connections: Sports Edition today?

Michigan Teams - LIONS, PISTONS, SPARTANS, TIGERS

Outcomes in an at-bat - FIELDER'S CHOICE, HIT, STRIKE-OUT, WALK

"Red" Teams - RED BULLS, RED SOX, RED STORM, RED WINGS

____Card - BASEBALL, LINEUP, RED, WILD

Don't feel down if you didn't manage to guess it this time. There will be new sports Connections for you to stretch your brain with tomorrow, and we'll be back again to guide you with more helpful hints.

Are you also playing NYT Strands? See hints and answers for today's Strands.

If you're looking for more puzzles, Mashable's got games now! Check out our games hub for Mahjong, Sudoku, free crossword, and more.

Not the day you're after? Here's the solution to the latest Connections.

Additionally, each group is color-coded with yellow being the easiest, followed by green, blue, and purple.

Mashable Tech

The Government Must Not Force Companies to Participate in AI-powered Surveillance

Corynne McSherry · EFF Deeplinks

Update:

On March 24, 2026, the Northern District of California granted Anthropic’s Motion for Preliminary Injunction, finding that the government’s actions were not designed to protect national security, but rather to punish Anthropic. “Punishing Anthropic for bringing public scrutiny to the government’s contracting position is classic illegal First Amendment retaliation.”

The rapidly escalating conflict between Anthropic and the Pentagon, which started when the company refused to let the government use its technology to spy on Americans, has now gone to court. The Department of Defense retaliated by designating the company a “supply chain risk” (SCR). Now, Anthropic is asking courts to block the designation, arguing that the First Amendment does not permit the government to coerce a private actor to rewrite its code to serve government ends.

We agree.

As EFF, the Foundation for Individual Rights and Expression, and multiple other public interest organizations explained in a brief filed in support of Anthropic’s motion, the development and operation of large language models involve multiple expressive choices protected by the First Amendment. Requiring a company to rewrite its code to remove guardrails means compelling different expression, a clear constitutional violation. Further, the public record shows that the SCR designation is intended to punish the company both for pushing back and for its CEO’s public statements explaining that AI may supercharge surveillance practices that current law has proven ill-equipped to address.

As we also explain, the company’s concerns about how the government will use its technology are well-founded. The U. S. government has a long history of illegally surveilling its citizens without adequate judicial oversight based on questionable interpretations of its Constitutional and statutory obligations. The Department of Defense acquires vast troves of personal information from commercial entities, including individuals’ physical location, social media, and web browsing data. Other government agencies continue to collect and query vast quantities of Americans’ information, including by acquiring information from third party data brokers.

A growing body of social science research illustrates the chilling effects of these pervasive activities. Fearing retribution for unpopular views, dissenters stay silent. And AI only exacerbates the problem. AI can quickly analyze the government’s massive datasets or combine that information with data scraped off the internet, purchased through the commercial data broker market, or from local police surveillance devices and use all of that data to construct

a comprehensive picture of a person’s life and infer sensitive details like their religious beliefs, medical conditions, political opinions, or even sex partners. For example, an agency could use AI to infer an individual’s association with a particular mosque based on data showing that they visited its website, followed its social media accounts, and were located near the mosque during religious services. AI can also deanonymize online speech by using public information to unmask anonymous users.

It is easy to conceive how an agency, a government employee with improper intent, or a malicious hacker could exploit these capabilities to monitor public discourse, preemptively squelch dissent, or persecute people from marginalized communities. Against this background and absent meaningful changes to the governing national security laws and judicial oversight structure, it is entirely reasonable for Anthropic—or any other company—to insist on its own guardrails.

Without action from Congress, the task of protecting your privacy has fallen in large part to Big Tech—something no one wants, including Big Tech. But if Congress won’t do it, companies like Anthropic must be allowed to step in, without facing retribution.

Hurdle hints and answers for March 29, 2026

Mashable Tech

If you like playing daily word games like Wordle, then Hurdle is a great game to add to your routine.

There are five rounds to the game. The first round sees you trying to guess the word, with correct, misplaced, and incorrect letters shown in each guess. If you guess the correct answer, it'll take you to the next hurdle, providing the answer to the last hurdle as your first guess. This can give you several clues or none, depending on the words. For the final hurdle, every correct answer from previous hurdles is shown, with correct and misplaced letters clearly shown.

An important note is that the number of times a letter is highlighted from previous guesses does necessarily indicate the number of times that letter appears in the final hurdle.

If you find yourself stuck at any step of today's Hurdle, don't worry! We have you covered.

SEE ALSO:

Hurdle: Everything you need to know to find the answers

Hurdle Word 1 hint

Susceptible.

SEE ALSO:

Apple's new M3 MacBook Air is \$300 off at Amazon. And yes, I'm tempted.

Hurdle Word 1 answer

PRONE

Hurdle Word 2 hint

A two-legged stand.

SEE ALSO:

Wordle today: Answer, hints for March 29, 2026

Hurdle Word 2 Answer

BIPOD

Hurdle Word 3 hint

A Greek letter.

SEE ALSO:

NYT Connections Sports Edition today: Hints and answers for March 29

SEE ALSO:

NYT Connections hints to-

Sony headphones and earbuds are majorly marked down during Amazons Big Spring sale

Mashable Tech

The star of headphone deals during Amazon's Big Spring Sale is Sony. All the best models of Sony headphones are on sale, making for major savings. Even Sony's latest flagship headphones, the Sony WH-1000XM6 headphones, are down to their lowest price ever.

If you're after a pair of Sony headphones, we've rounded up all the best deals on the brand's headphones and earbuds.

SEE ALSO:

Live updates on Amazon Big Spring Sale 2026: Record-low prices on Apple MacBooks, DJI drones, and Kindles

Best Sony deal

Opens in a new window

Credit: Sony

Sony WH-1000XM6 Headphones

\$398 at Amazon

\$459.99 Save \$61.99

Why we like it

The Sony WH-1000XM6 aren't even a year old and are still the latest headphones in Sony's flagship lineup. We've tracked the headphones price through last year's Prime Day, waiting for a noteworthy price, and finally, we have one.

Now, you can get the Sony WH-1000XM6 headphones for \$398. According to Camelcamel, that brings them back down to their all-time low that we first spotted during Black Friday 2025.

Now, during Amazon's Big Spring Sale, you can find the headphones for 13% off and save on stellar audio in a pair of headphones designed for a true audiophile.

Sony headphones deals

Sony WH-CH520 headphones — \$42.95 \$69.99 (save \$27.04)

IN BRIEF

The New Yorker, The New Yorker: The mega-popular K-pop stars have been on hiatus for nearly four years. Their new album, "Arirang," tests the group's staying power in the global cultural marketplace.

Juan Sebastián Urrego Escobar, Serverless Blog: Part 4 of 5 with our series and its time to start implementing our architecture in code and configuration using some appropriate design patterns and following a Function as a Microservice style.

Maciej Winnicki, Serverless Blog: How do you design a tool that tows the line between 'exciting new ground' and 'real world practicality'? We asked a lot of those questions with the Event Gateway.

Eric Wyne, Serverless Blog: When the California Camp Fire displaced thousands of people from their homes, I built a simple serverless Twitter bot to help people get placed in temporary housing!

Eric Schmitt and Helene Cooper, NYT Top Stories: Marines training in Okinawa, Japan, last year. Marines from the 31st Marine Expeditionary Unit have been sent to the Middle East, though it is unclear what they will be used for.

Maciej Skierkowski, Serverless Blog: Announcing the general availability of Serverless CI/CD in Serverless Framework Pro, a continuous integration and deployment service you can use for free.

BBC News, BBC News: Tottenham Hotspur want to convince Roberto de Zerbi to become their new permanent head coach, after the departure of interim boss Igor Tudor.

Eslam Hefnawy, Serverless Blog: Create unit tests for Node.js using the Serverless Framework, run tests on CI, and check off our list of serverless testing best practices.

Eslam Hefnawy, Serverless Blog: This is a walkthrough on how easy it is to use both Serverless Cloud and Upstash together to easily and quickly offer your users the app performance they deserve.

Alex DeBrie, Serverless Blog: Handling Python dependencies in your Lambda functions can be a pain. Here's how I handle Python packaging with Serverless for dev/prod parity.

Ananya Bhattacharya, Rest of World: The biggest obstacle to electric-vehicle charging infrastructure is turning out to be the neighbors. Communities across dozens of countries are fighting EV charging station installations, citing fire hazards, ugly design,...

BBC News, BBC News: With one game to go until Thomas Tuchel picks his England World Cup squad, BBC Sport reporters choose their starting XIs for the summer. Who would you pick?

Stefanie Monge, Serverless Blog: The official OpenWhisk plugin for Serverless now includes support for Cloudbant DB and IBM

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